

Session 17: The Marketing Design Workshop

Key Points...

1. Design for instant trust and instant visual understanding.
 - The purpose of great design is not to call attention to itself.
 - The purpose of great design is to create trust, amplify the message, and create instant visual understanding.
2. Start with a Dominant Visual Element, then Visual Hierarchy.
 - Eyes are pulled to the "dominant" visual element - so make the most important thing in your design the BIGGEST thing.
 - Make your second-most-important element half as big as your dominant element.
 - Follow this logic throughout your design.
3. Work with the "physics" of what's called "Reading Gravity."
 - We are trained to read (in the Western world) left to right and top to bottom.
 - The eye naturally starts in the upper left, and moves to the lower right.
 - Don't ask the eye to go against Reading Gravity!
4. Keep Designs SUPER Simple.
 - Complex designs confuse, so avoid them.
 - In your design, use no more than 1-2 fonts, font sizes, alignments, colors, etc.
 - Great designers create simple, intuitive designs with very few elements.
5. Use a large, bold, clear headline to call attention to your message.
 - When working with print, broadcast your key message with a big, bold headline.
 - For added effect, put your headline in "quotes."
 - Use emotional power words for maximum impact.